SDVOSB Certification

Worksheet Pack

Companion to the book 'The SDVOSB Handbook: How to get your veteran-owned business certified by the SBA'.

This is a private study aid. It is not a government form, it is not an official document, and filling it in does not apply for or confer any certification.

You apply for SDVOSB certification only through the U.S. Small Business Administration at certifications.sba.gov, and it is free. Nobody needs to charge you to file it.

These are the fill-in tools from the book, on paper, where you can actually use them. Print this pack and keep it with your formation documents.

Work through them in order. Each one corresponds to a chapter, and the chapter explains why the worksheet asks what it asks. The worksheets are not a substitute for reading the chapters -- most of the expensive mistakes in this process are ones a checklist cannot warn you about.

Free to copy. Veteran service officers, APEX Accelerator and VBOC counselors, and veteran organizations may reproduce and distribute this pack for client use without asking.

What is in here

1. Eligibility screener - five minutes, before anything else
2. The canonical string - the single most useful page
3. Document checklist - what each step consumes
4. Timeline tracker - dates, so you know where you are
5. Pre-submission consistency check - do this before you file
6. Your state's rules - the half of this that is not federal

Rules change. Check the date on the book's copyright page, and the book's links page, before relying on anything here.

1. Eligibility screener

Answer honestly. A 'No' is not necessarily the end -- read the note under each one. See Chapters 1, 6, and 7.

Service connection

Has the VA determined that you have a service-connected disability, at any rating - including 0 percent? ☐ Yes ☐ No

A 0 percent rating is an adjudicated service connection and meets the statutory definition. If No, you may still qualify as a veteran-owned small business (VOSB). See Chapter 1.

Ownership

Do you directly own at least 51 percent of the business? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is that ownership free of any condition, option, or agreement that could take it away or dilute it? ☐ Yes ☐ No

'Directly' matters - ownership held through another entity is treated differently. See Chapter 6.

Control

Do you control long-term decision-making for the business? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you control day-to-day operations? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there ANY person who can veto, block, or must consent to your decisions - in the operating agreement, a side agreement, or a loan document? ☐ Yes ☐ No

A 'Yes' to that last question is the most common reason applications are denied. It is fixable before you apply. Chapter 7 is entirely about this.

If you cannot run the business day to day

Has the VA determined, in writing, that you are permanently and totally disabled? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Are you unable to manage the daily business operations? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Both must be Yes for the spouse-or-permanent-caregiver provision to apply. A P&T rating alone does not trigger it. Get professional help with the drafting - Chapter 7.

Size

Is the business small under the SBA size standard for your NAICS codes? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Your NAICS codes _____

Size standard _____

2. The canonical string

Write your legal name and address here ONCE, exactly as it appears on your state record. Then copy from this page every single time you are asked - state filings, the IRS, your bank, SAM.gov, VetCert.

Never retype it. Punctuation and spacing mismatches between systems are a leading cause of delays measured in weeks, and are among the most cited reasons for requests for information. See Chapters 5 and 11.

Legal business name

_____

Include the entity designator (LLC, L.L.C., Inc.). Note whether there is a comma before it. ASCII characters only.

Business address

Street _____

Unit / Suite _____

City _____

State / ZIP _____

Watch for: a period after a street abbreviation, '#' versus 'Apt' versus 'Unit', and whether the unit is on its own line.

Identifiers

EIN _____

State document no. _____

Formation date _____

UEI (after SAM) _____

Formation date is the date the STATE processed the filing, which may be a day later than your payment receipt. Use the state's.

Where this string has been used

Tick each as you confirm it matches this page character for character.

- [ ] State formation record
- [ ] IRS / EIN letter (CP 575)
- [ ] Business bank account title
- [ ] SAM.gov entity registration
- [ ] VetCert application
- [ ] Operating agreement

3. Document checklist

Gather these once and reuse them. The right-hand notes say where each is consumed.

- [ ] Articles of organization / formation document - Bank, VetCert
- [ ] Certificate of good standing - Bank - often must be under 60 days old
- [ ] EIN confirmation letter (CP 575) - Bank, SAM, VetCert
- [ ] Executed operating agreement - Bank, VetCert - notarized if possible
- [ ] Most recent state annual report - VetCert
- [ ] DD-214 - VetCert - proves service and discharge character
- [ ] VA benefit summary letter - VetCert - proves service connection
- [ ] VA service verification letter - VetCert
- [ ] VA rating decision, if held - Supporting
- [ ] Written VA P&T determination, if applicable - Only for the caregiver provision
- [ ] Photo identification - Bank
- [ ] Beneficial owner form - Bank completes this with you, by phone
- [ ] Bank letter or statement showing ACH routing - SAM.gov EFT section

Name the files to match this list. When an application asks for an exhibit, you want to find it in seconds rather than opening six PDFs to see which is which.

4. Timeline tracker

Fill in dates as you go. The point is to see where you actually are, and to catch a step that has silently stalled.

Entity filed	_____	*Payment receipt received?*
Entity confirmed by state	_____	*Document number:*
Entity record verified correct	_____	*Read the public record*
EIN obtained	_____	*CP 575 saved?*
EIN + 2 weeks (do not touch SAM before)	_____	*The propagation wait*
Bank: personal membership opened	_____	
Bank: initial deposit CONFIRMED POSTED	_____	*Not just submitted*
Bank: business application submitted	_____	
Bank: documents uploaded	_____	
Bank: required phone call completed	_____	*Within 2 business days*
Bank: account open, ACH routing in hand	_____	
SAM.gov registration started	_____	
SAM.gov entity validation cleared	_____	*The step most likely to stall*
SAM.gov ACTIVE	_____	
VetCert application submitted	_____	
VetCert decision	_____	

If a date is more than two weeks old with no movement and no explanation, something has stalled. Silence is not progress - check your email, including spam, and then call.

5. Pre-submission consistency check

Most denials and requests for information come from documents that disagree with each other, not from applicants who were ineligible. Run this before you submit anything.

Does everything match, character for character?

- [ ] Legal name identical on: state record, IRS letter, bank account title, SAM, VetCert
- [ ] Address identical across all five - including unit format and punctuation
- [ ] EIN identical everywhere it appears
- [ ] Formation date matches the STATE record, not the payment receipt
- [ ] Your name spelled identically everywhere, including middle initial or its absence
- [ ] Your title consistent (manager / managing member) across documents

Control

- [ ] Operating agreement names you as sole member and sole manager
- [ ] No consent right, veto, quorum, supermajority, or deadlock provision anywhere - including schedules
- [ ] A clause expressly voiding any such provision
- [ ] No other person appears on the state record
- [ ] No side agreement, loan covenant, or investor document grants anyone approval rights
- [ ] You hold the highest officer position
- [ ] You take the highest compensation, or you can document why not

Completeness

- [ ] Every document on checklist 3 gathered and named
- [ ] Operating agreement executed, and notarized if possible
- [ ] Notarized PDF unmodified since signing - never re-save it
- [ ] Certificate of good standing still within its validity window
- [ ] SAM registration ACTIVE, not merely submitted

If you cannot tick a box, that is the work. An application submitted with a known gap does not move faster - it comes back as a request for information, and the clock restarts.

6. Your state's rules

The federal half of this process - EIN, SAM.gov, VetCert - is the same everywhere. The state half is not. Fill this page in once, from your own state's filing office, and you will never have to guess at these again.

Find your state's office by searching your state's name plus 'Secretary of State business filing'. Confirm the address ends in .gov before entering anything.

Your filing office

Office name _____

Website (.gov) _____

Phone _____

The three numbers

Formation fee _____

Annual/biennial report fee _____

Late penalty _____

Ask specifically whether the late penalty can be waived. In many states it cannot, for any reason.

The dates

Report filing window opens _____

Report deadline _____

Deadline falls on a weekend? _____

If the deadline is a Saturday or Sunday, your real deadline is the business day before. Write that date in your calendar, not the official one.

Registered agent

Who is your agent _____

Days to report a resignation _____

A resigned agent that goes unreplaced is a common route to administrative dissolution - and the notice goes to the address on file, which may be one you no longer check.

Address rules

- ☐ PO box accepted as principal address? (usually no)
- ☐ PO box accepted for registered agent? (usually no)
- ☐ Is your address published publicly?

If your company is not currently in good standing

Reinstatement possible until _____

Reinstatement cost _____

- [ ] Does reinstatement preserve the ORIGINAL formation date?
- [ ] Certificate of good standing: cost and how long it stays valid

The freshness window matters - banks commonly require a certificate file-stamped within the last 60 days, and a slow account application can outlive one.